

# Mini Lesson Sample Script

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**Materials:** Centimeter cubes, new crayon, dry erase marker, small glue stick

## 1. Measure the length of a crayon using centimeter cubes.

How long is the crayon?

*Answer: The crayon is 9 centimeter cubes long.*

T: Today we are going to measure how long things are using these centimeter cubes. Here is a crayon. I am going to put my first cube right here. Does this look right to you?

S: No. The cube has to start where the crayon starts.

T: Good catch. Why does that matter?

S: If the cube doesn't start at the end of the crayon, we are missing part of the crayon.

T: Let's line it up with the endpoint. Now I'll add another cube. (Place the second cube next to the first.) Watch this one. (Place a third cube with a small gap.) Does this look right?

S: There's a space between them. You have to push them together.

T: Why does the space matter?

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|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <p>S: Because part of the crayon is not getting counted.</p> <p>T: Fix it for me, then finish lining up cubes all the way to the other end.</p> <p>S: (Lines up cubes with no gaps or overlaps to the end of the crayon.)</p> <p>T: Let's count together. Touch each cube as we count.</p> <p>S: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9.</p> <p>T: How long is the crayon? Say the whole sentence.</p> <p>S: The crayon is 9 centimeter cubes long.</p> |
| <p><b>2. Choose the picture that shows the correct way to measure the dry erase marker. How long is the marker?</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <p>Picture A: A dry erase marker with 5 centimeter cubes lined up below it. The first cube starts past the left end of the marker, and the last cube ends before the right end of the marker. There are no gaps between cubes.</p> <p>Picture B: A dry erase marker with 7 centimeter cubes lined up below it. The first cube is lined up</p> | <p>T: Now look at these three pictures of a dry erase marker. Only one shows the right way to measure. Let's look at Picture A first. Does the first cube line up with the end of the marker?</p> <p>S: No. The cubes start in the middle. Part of the marker is missing.</p> <p>T: So Picture A is not right. What about Picture B?</p>                                                                                                   |

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| <p>with the left end of the marker, but two of the cubes in the middle overlap each other.</p> <p>Picture C: A dry erase marker with 6 centimeter cubes lined up below it. The first cube is lined up with the left end of the marker, and each cube is placed end to end with no gaps and no overlaps, reaching the other end of the marker.</p> <p><i>Answer: Picture C; the marker is 6 centimeter cubes long.</i></p> | <p>S: Two cubes are on top of each other. They overlap.</p> <p>T: What happens when cubes overlap?</p> <p>S: We count the same part of the marker twice.</p> <p>T: Right. Now look at Picture C. Does the first cube start at the end of the marker?</p> <p>S: Yes.</p> <p>T: Any gaps or overlaps?</p> <p>S: No. They are all right next to each other.</p> <p>T: Then Picture C shows correct measuring. Count the cubes.</p> <p>S: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6.</p> <p>T: How long is the marker?</p> <p>S: The marker is 6 centimeter cubes long.</p> |
| <p><b>3. Measure the length of the glue stick using centimeter cubes.</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <p>How long is the glue stick?</p> <p><i>Answer: The glue stick is 8 centimeter cubes long.</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <p>T: Here is a glue stick. Measure it on your own with the centimeter cubes. Remember to start at the endpoint and watch for gaps and overlaps.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

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|  | S: (Works.) |
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